

Nursing Department Guidelines

Nursing Care Standards

- Every inpatient has an individualized nursing care plan developed within the first shift after admission.
- Vital signs are checked per the frequency set by the attending physician, with a minimum of once every 8 hours for stable patients.
- Nurses document care using the standard nursing notes format at every shift.

Shift Handover

- Handover between shifts uses the SBAR format and occurs at the patient's bedside whenever possible.
- Outstanding tasks, pending results, and any safety concerns must be explicitly communicated at handover.

Nurse-to-Patient Ratios

- General wards maintain a target ratio of 1 nurse to 6 patients per shift.
- Intensive Care Units maintain a target ratio of 1 nurse to 2 patients per shift.

Infection Control

- Hand hygiene is performed before and after every patient contact, following the WHO 'Five Moments for Hand Hygiene'.
- Personal protective equipment (PPE) is used according to the patient's isolation precautions (contact, droplet, or airborne).